Cesar Augusto Lopez

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Research interests

Economic development policy and finance, causal inference, remote sensing, artificial intelligence, agricultural and natural resource economics, social network theory and analysis.

Education

2026 **Ph.D. in Environment and Resources**, Stanford University
2025 **M.A. in Economics**, Stanford University
2013 **B.A. in Economics**, University of California, Berkeley

Professional experience

2026–*current*	External Research Consultant, Inter-American Development Bank (IDB)
2015–2019	Research Fellow, Inter-American Development Bank (IDB)
2014–2015	Research Analyst, AidGrade, Berkeley, CA
2013–2014	Research Assistant, University of California, Berkeley

Work in progress

The role of development finance institutions in advancing sustainable irrigation (with Rosamond L. Naylor and James H. Jones) [*Manuscript submitted and under review*]

Short-term impacts of participatory irrigation development on household welfare: Evidence from Bolivia (with Lina Salazar, Mario Gonzáles-Flores, and Luis Enrique Miranda)

Local economic effects of participatory irrigation development

Irrigation and agricultural development among smallholders: Geospatial evidence from Bolivia

Social network structure for agricultural policy and sustainable development (with James H. Jones)

Agricultural input subsidies, food security, and rural poverty in El Salvador

Peer-reviewed publications

Turner, M. A., Signleton, A. L., Harris, M. J., **Lopez, C. A.**, Harryman, I., Arthur, R. F., ... & Jones, J. H. (2023). Minority-group incubators and majority-group reservoirs for promoting the diffusion of climate change and public health adaptations. *Philosophical Transactions of the Royal Society B*, 378(1889), 20220401

Working papers

Aramburu, J., Garone, L. F., Maffioli, A., Salazar, L., & **Lopez, C. A.** (2019). *Direct and spillover effects of agricultural technology adoption programs: Experimental evidence from the Dominican Republic* (IDB Working Paper No. IDB-WP-00971). Inter-American Development Bank.

Teaching experience

Remote sensing of land (Stanford University)

Pursuing sustainability: Managing complex social–environmental systems (Stanford University)

Capstone project seminar in environment and resources (Stanford University)

Conference presentations

2024: Natural Capital Symposium 2024–Mainstreaming Nature in Policy & Investment Decisions; Stanford University, California, June 6

2023: Bolivian Conference on Development Economics (BCDE); La Paz, Bolivia, November 9-10

2022: Western Economic Association International (WEAI) Conference; session on Health Care, Pensions, Agricultural Investments and Macroeconomic Shocks (Virtual, Discussant), June 30

2018: Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Meeting, Washington, D.C., August 5–7

2018: International Conference of Agricultural Economists (ICAE), Vancouver, Canada, Jul. 28–Aug 2

2017: International Association of Agricultural Economists (IAAE) Inter-Conference Symposium. University of Talca, Chile, October 17–19

Grants, fellowships, scholarships, and awards

Stanford-Tinker Foundation Research Funding ($27,000), 2024.

Stanford's King Center on Global Development's Graduate Student Research Funding: Advanced award ($12,000), 2024

Emmett Interdisciplinary Program in Environment & Resources (E-IPER) Research Grant ($4,000), 2024

Stanford's King Center on Global Development's Graduate Student Research Funding ($5,000), 2023

Stanford Doerr School of Sustainability (SDSS) Research Grant ($2,300), 2023

Stanford's Center on Philanthropy and Civil Society (PACS), Small Grants Program ($2,000), 2023

Emmett Interdisciplinary Program in Environment & Resources (E-IPER) Research Grant ($4,000), 2023

George Mason University's Institute for Humane Studies (IHS) Expense Support Grant ($5,000), 2023

Stanford Doerr School of Sustainability (SDSS) Fellowship, 2023

Hispanic Scholarship Fund (HSF) Scholarship, 2023

Emmett Interdisciplinary Program in Environment & Resources (E-IPER) Research Grant ($4,000), 2022

Stanford Earth Research Grant ($2,000), 2022

BNY Mellon/Hispanic Scholarship Fund (HSF) Scholarship ($5,000), 2022

Emmett Interdisciplinary Program in Environment & Resources (E-IPER) Research Grant ($4,000), 2021

Emmett Interdisciplinary Program in Environment & Resources (E-IPER) Research Grant ($4,000), 2020

Stanford Earth Dean's Doctoral Fellowship, 2019-2022

Stanford's Enhancing Diversity in Graduate Education (EDGE) Doctoral Fellowship, 2019

Professional activities

American Economic Association (AEA) Mentoring Program, 2021-2025

Additional information

Citizenship: United States, El Salvador

Languages: Spanish *(native)*, English *(fluent)*, Portuguese (*beginner*)

Technical Skills: R, Python, Stata, LaTeX, GIS, Google Earth Engine (GEE), SQL

Dissertation committee

Rosamond L. Naylor (co-primary advisor)
Stanford Doerr School of Sustainability

James Holland Jones (co-primary advisor)
Stanford Doerr School of Sustainability

David Lobell (reader)
Dept. of Earth System Science

Marshall Burke (reader)
Stanford Doerr School of Sustainability

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